TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 14, 2022
6:00 PM
REVISED

BUDGET HEARING

Note: December 6, 2022 Published Advertisement

Mayor Williams opened the budget hearing at 6:01 pm. Town Administrator Milie stated this is the 3rd budget hearing. The only revision made since the last hearing was the $3,000 in fire subscription was moved to parks/events. There were no questions from Council or citizens. **Council Member Ward made a motion to close the hearing with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion was passed unanimously.**

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.

At 6:05, Mayor Williams opened the regular agenda hearing. Stella Lavin, 3125 Robertson Ave, asked for an update on the website. Town Administrator Milie stated an update will be given during his Administrator Report.

There were no other questions at this time so Mayor Williams asked Council Member Drohan to present TDRUP Project. This project is looking at undeveloped property to see how much water & sewer will be needed. What kind of infrastructure is needed and the cost of those needs. A short PowerPoint on the data collected was shown. Council Member Drohan stated this information will help P & Z make zoning and variance decisions. Council will use this information on policy decisions. The data collected shows there will be a need for the Town to purchase water from Savannah and the sewer capacity is already in the cushion Public Works Director Crosby would like to have.

There was still time before the regular meeting needed to start so Town Administrator Milie reported on the website. This project is taking longer than expected. The timeline shows a Spring of 2023 for completion. He was able to show the navigation method for the site. The next step is to migrate the current website information over to the new developed site. Mayor Williams asked for a push to have the website completed by the Blessing of the Fleet.

Town Administrator Milie provided an update for Thunderbolt Tidy. This effort started in June. In the four months of activity, no clean up in July, twenty-five streets have been covered. There have been a collection of trash and bulk items of six, half ton truckloads. The trees have been assessed and bushes have been trimmed.

Closed hearing at 6:30 pm

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

Those in attendance were Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Bethany Skipper-Greer, David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan, James Lavin and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Utilities/Accts. Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman and Public Works Director, Oscar Crosby.

All members are in attendance

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
Minutes of November 9, 2022

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the November 9, 2022 meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentations:**

a) Employee Recognition

Mayor Williams and Town Administrator Milie recognized Katina Spaulding 15 years of service and Attorney Charles Barrow for over 25 years' service for the Town of Thunderbolt.

b) Presentation of the Heroic Citizen's Award

Rusty Hunter was honored for his heroic act where he helped remove a victim from a burning car. Mayor Williams presented Mr. Hunter with one of the mayor's coins.

c) Finance Report:

Shannon Brett, Holland, Bromley, Barhill & Brett LLP, was in attendance to provide the financial report. Town Administrator Milie stated he had a question from Council Member Crenshaw about the water & sewer revenue in the executive summary. It was explained the 2022 budget was set on the old water rate not the new rate that went into effect in March. That is why it is ahead of the budgeted amount. Mayor Williams stated this is the first time in his history the town has not had to purchase water from Savannah. Ms. Brett explained the overall revenues are in line with the 2022 budget. The expenses are under budget. Staff is working to close out the accounts on December 31st. There was a meeting with United Bank on the cash accounts. Staff is also looking into the Georgia Fund as an alternative. A recommendation will be made in the new year. Council Member Crenshaw asked about the commitment. Ms. Brett did not think there is a required time. Council Member Ward asked if they could see both presentations. Town Administrator Milie stated using United limits their ability to control the funds as with the GA Fund does and it is designed for only governments and state agencies.

6. **Planning & Zoning Public Hearing**

a) Town of Thunderbolt request a map amendment for the parcels below to a mixed-use classification of the River Drive District:

Parcel #: 30004 08013
Address: 2701 River Dr, Thunderbolt, GA 31404
Owner: Robert Shuman
Current Zoning: Victory Drive District

Parcel #: 30004 08012
Address: 2703 River Dr, Thunderbolt, GA 31404
Owner: Thomas Howard
Current Zoning: Victory Drive District

Mayor Williams opened the planning and zoning hearing. Town Administrator Milie explained this is a reconsideration. These two properties are in the Victory Drive District but face River Drive. The owners were contacted and there were no objections. **Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to approve the two parcels being rezoned for River Drive District with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously. Councill Member Ward made the motion to close the planning & zoning hearing with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

7. **Consent Agenda:**

   a) Approval of the 2023 Alcohol License Renewals. Staff Recommends Approval.

   b) Approval of the 2023 Home Occupation License Renewals. Staff Recommends Approval.

   c) Approval of the 2023 Outdoor Event Licenses Renewals. Staff Recommends Approval.

Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the consent agenda with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. Council Member Barbaree brought up there are two regular businesses not on the alcohol list and instead of having them wait until next month's meeting, staff should be able to approve them if they meet all the criteria. Mayor Williams asked if Council Member Ward would like to withdrawal his motion and he agreed. Council Member Ward made the motion to approved item 7b and 7c. with a second from Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously. Item 7 a. **Council Member Barbaree asked for approval of those on the list and allow staff to approve the businesses that are not on the list that are renewing the license. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

   a) Approval of 2023 Annual Budget.

      Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the budget resolution. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

   b) Approval of Chatham County Tax Commission Intergovernmental Agreement for Property Tax Collection. Staff Recommends Approval

      Town Administrator Milie explained several years ago the town started the process to have the County take over taxes. It was decided to keep taxes in house. This agreement will cost about $6,000 to $7,000. Their collection rate is at 98%. There will be a $3,000 savings not using Qs1. Mayor Williams called for a motion to approve. Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police

Chief Clayton explained his participation in assisting with the active shooter call at Savannah High School. He explained he heard it on the radio and responded. When he got inside the school, officers were clearing one wing on the second floor on one side and evacuating the classrooms. He assisted evacuating the other side of the 2nd floor. He commended the teachers and students on hiding properly in the classroom. Mayor Williams stated Chiefs usually do not participate in tactical stuff. Our Chief did. He grabbed his gun and went in to harms way. Town Administrator Milie spoke of Johnson High School being in Thunderbolt and the backup from other departments. He stated Council has approved the proper tools to face this type of situation. Chief Clayton and Lt Runyon went to Johnson High School to help with their soft lockdown. Parents were showing up to pick up their students because of the incident.

Council Member Drohan asked about the car thefts at Warsaw. Chief Clayton stated the keys were left in the vehicles. There are some individuals looking for unlocked vehicles to steal from.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Chief Bateman stated they are at final touches on the training room. Chief Bateman has moved his office upstairs. There is remediation of mold downstairs around the windows and the showers to be addressed.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Director Crosby stated the Chlorides are down 20 parts per million. Mayor Williams stated many people have commented to him on how great the town looks. Director Crosby stated there will be a shut off valve plan to start next year.

Anna Maria Thomas, Thunderbolt Museum, updated the Council. They had their last yard sale for 2022. She thanked the Fire Department for always helping. She stated they are starting Arts & Crafts and Canning Classes next year. Other activity coming up next year is silent auctions.

10. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator stated a more formal year-end review will be in February. He is waiting on Local Option Sales Tax decision. Council Member Crenshaw stated our mayor is going to the next Chatham County Commission with the other Mayors on Friday.

Mayor Williams remarked how things have been going so well since Milie came on board. Town staff work so well together.

Council Member Drohan asked if it would be possible to have a recreation workshop in the beginning of the year. Town Administrator Milie and Mayor Williams both replied they are already planning for one.

Council Member Lavin asked about how LOST is distributed, yearly. Town Administrator Milie stated it comes monthly.

11. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

No report

12. **Mayor and Council –**

a) TDRUP Ad hoc Committee Council Member Drohan

Mayor Williams asked if there was any other business. Hearing none, he asked for motion to adjourn. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

13. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters.

14. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 7:28 pm.

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion